

Teacher Guide

History | Grade 9-12 | Chapter 5: The French Revolution

Period 1: Introduction to the French Revolution

Entry Ticket: What do you think is meant by the terms 'liberty' and 'equality'? Can you provide examples from your life where you've experienced or seen these concepts in action?

Teacher Script: Good morning, class! Today, we're diving into a significant and transformative event in history: the French Revolution. Before we get started, let's talk about the concepts that are central to this topic: liberty, equality, and citizenship.

As you consider your responses to the warm-up question, think about how these terms relate to what you've seen or experienced in your own lives. These concepts were foundational not just for the revolution, but also for Europe as a whole, laying the groundwork for modern democracy.

Now, let's take a brief moment to look back at the 18th century to understand what conditions in Europe were like. France was divided into three estates: the clergy, the nobility, and the commoners, where the Third Estate represented the common people, including peasants and the middle class. The inequalities and hardships they faced played a huge role in sparking the revolution.

Also, we'll discuss key events like the storming of the Bastille, which symbolized the uprising against tyranny. The echoes of the revolution were felt not just in France, but across the world as the principles of liberty and equality began to inspire movements for democracy.

Throughout today's lesson, I will be asking you questions to explore your understanding and encourage you to think about the significance of these ideas, both back then and now.

Blackboard Notes: Topic: The French Revolution

Key Concepts: liberty, equality, citizenship

Importance of Estates in France: Clergy, Nobility, Commoners (Third Estate)

Significance of the Storming of the Bastille

Principles influenced later movements for democracy and human rights

Activity (Group Work, 25 min): 1. Divide students into small groups of 4-5. 2. Assign each group one of the three estates (Clergy, Nobility, Commoners). 3. Provide each group with the printed handouts and materials. 4. Instruct them to identify and write down key characteristics of their assigned estate and the challenges they faced on the poster paper. 5. Each group will then present their findings while the others take notes. 6. After presentations, use sticky notes for students to write one question each about another estate that they found intriguing.

Activity (Role Play, 20 min): 1. Prepare scripts that depict key moments leading up to the French Revolution (e.g., a meeting of the Estates-General or a conversation among commoners discussing their frustrations). 2.

Divide the class into small groups and assign roles from the scripts. 3. Give them 10 minutes to rehearse and then 10 minutes to perform for the class. 4. Encourage them to express their feelings about liberty and equality through their characters.

Exit Ticket: Reflecting on today's lesson, how do the principles of liberty and equality relate to current issues in society? Write a short paragraph explaining your thoughts.

Homework: Read the section on the Reign of Terror in your textbook. Prepare to discuss how this period affected the course of the French Revolution and the lives of its citizens.

Mentor Moment: Let me share a story about a young activist named Eliza. Inspired by the principles of liberty and equality, she often rallied her peers for community causes. One day, during a school event, she stood before her classmates and spoke passionately about the importance of standing up for what is right, even when it seems like a daunting task. Eliza's leadership reminds us that the ideals we'll discuss today are not just historical; they can be a call to action for each of us to advocate for justice and equality in our own communities. Just like the revolutionaries of France, we all have the potential to make a difference.

Period 2: Causes of the Revolution

Entry Ticket: What do you think were some of the reasons the French people wanted change in their society during the late 18th century?

Teacher Script: Good morning, class! Today, we are diving into the fascinating and complex causes of the French Revolution. First, let's think for a moment about the social structure of France back in the 18th century. How many estates were there, and who belonged to them? The answer lies in a society deeply divided by class-knowing this context is essential as we explore why change was necessary.

Now, let's identify the three estates. Who can remind us what the Third Estate was comprised of? Yes, that's correct! The Third Estate consisted of commoners, including peasants and the middle class. This brings us to our next point: what kind of power did they have compared to the First and Second Estates? Not much at all! They were heavily taxed and had little representation.

Now, as we transition in our discussion, let's focus on how this environment set the stage for the formation of the National Assembly. Can anyone explain why this was a pivotal moment? Excellent! The National Assembly was formed by the representatives of the Third Estate who felt sidelined by the existing power structure. By declaring themselves the National Assembly, they symbolized a shift in authority.

Let's further explore this together. I'll be writing down key points and asking questions along the way, so keep your minds sharp!

Blackboard Notes: Estates of France: 1st, 2nd, and 3rd Estates

1st Estate: Clergy

2nd Estate: Nobility

3rd Estate: Commoners (Peasants & Middle Class)

Formation of the National Assembly (1789)

Activity (Group Discussion, 20 min): 1. Divide the class into small groups (4-5 students each). 2. Assign each group one of the three estates (1st, 2nd, or 3rd) and ask them to discuss the frustrations and privileges of their assigned estate. 3. Each group will prepare a short presentation summarizing their discussions on a piece of chart paper. 4. After 10 minutes, have each group present their findings to the class. 5. As they present, encourage students to take notes on each estate and ask follow-up questions to deepen the discussion.

Activity (Role Play, 30 min): 1. Hand out role play cards to each student, indicating whether they are a member of the 1st, 2nd, or 3rd Estate. 2. Allow students a few minutes to prepare and think about the grievances and desires of their character. 3. Set up a 'meeting' scenario taking place just before the formation of the National Assembly. 4. Students will discuss their points of view in character. The 3rd Estate members should articulate their need for representation. After ten minutes, pause the discussions and have students step out of character for a debrief session about the experience.

Exit Ticket: In one sentence, explain why the Estates system contributed to the outbreak of the French Revolution.

Homework: Read Chapter 5, focusing on the causes and key events leading up to the formation of the National Assembly. Be prepared to discuss the implications of these events in our next class.

Mentor Moment: Consider this: the French Revolution sprung from the humble voices of the common people who sought equality, liberty, and a say in their governance. This reminds us that significant change often begins from the ground up, fueled by the passion and conviction of those who feel unheard. Every one of you has the potential to make a difference in your community. Just like the commoners of France became agents of change, you too can advocate for what you believe in.

Period 3: The Storming of the Bastille

Entry Ticket: What do you think was one of the main reasons that led to the storming of the Bastille?

Teacher Script: Good morning, class! Today, we're diving into a pivotal moment of the French Revolution: the storming of the Bastille. To start, I want you to think critically about what might have driven the people to take such drastic action. After discussing your thoughts with a partner, we'll look at the significance of this event. The storming of the Bastille was not just an attack on a prison; it marked a powerful symbol of the people's resistance against oppression. It was a clear statement that the old regime could no longer control the narrative. Now, let's explore some key concepts that will help us understand its importance. First, we'll discuss the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen, which emerged from this revolutionary fervor. How did this document reflect the ideals for which the revolutionaries were fighting? Let's delve into this together and uncover the meaning behind these historical events.

Blackboard Notes: The Storming of the Bastille - July 14, 1789

Significance: Symbol of Revolution

Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen

Key ideas: liberty, equality, citizenship

Activity (Role Play, 25 min): 1. Divide the class into small groups of 4-5 students. 2. Assign each group a specific role related to the storming of the Bastille (e.g., revolutionaries, royal guards, common citizens). 3.

Each group will use index cards to write down their motivations and perspectives regarding the event. 4. After preparation, each group will enact a short skit (3-5 minutes) representing their assigned roles during the storming of the Bastille. 5. After the skits, facilitate a discussion around the diverse viewpoints presented.

Activity (Group Discussion, 15 min): 1. After the role plays, gather students in a circle for a group discussion. 2. Ask students to reflect on what they learned about the significance of the storming of the Bastille and how it relates to the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen. 3. Have students write key points on the whiteboard as they share their thoughts, emphasizing themes of liberty, equality, and citizenship. 4. Guide the discussion to ensure all main ideas are addressed.

Exit Ticket: In one sentence, explain why the storming of the Bastille is seen as the beginning of the French Revolution.

Homework: Read the section on the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen and prepare a short paragraph discussing its main principles and their relevance to the French Revolution.

Mentor Moment: Let me tell you a story about my visit to France last year. I stood in front of the Bastille monument, and it struck me how a simple prison became a symbol of freedom, not just for the French, but for many around the world. It reminded me that sometimes, it only takes a brave group of individuals believing in a cause to ignite change. As we study the events of the French Revolution, remember that the ideals of liberty and equality resonate even today in movements for justice and human rights.

Period 4: The Reign of Terror

Entry Ticket: What do you think were the consequences of the Reign of Terror on the ideals of the French Revolution?

Teacher Script: Good morning, everyone! Today, we are diving into one of the most intense periods of the French Revolution - the Reign of Terror. As we explore this dark phase, I want you to keep in mind the ideals of liberty, equality, and citizenship that sparked the revolution. Start by discussing your thoughts on the entry ticket. I'll give you a few minutes to share your ideas with your partner.

(After a few minutes)

Now let's gather some thoughts. Who would like to share what they discussed?

(After listening to various responses)

Great insights! As we move forward, we will examine how the Reign of Terror epitomized the complexities of the revolution. This period saw extreme violence and political purges. Let's consider how these actions affected the revolution's original goals.

(Teacher presents images or videos related to the Reign of Terror, like the guillotine)

Look here, the guillotine, a symbol of this terror, represents not just the violence but also the fear that

encompassed society. As we analyze this period, keep these questions in mind: How did the actions taken during the Reign of Terror align or clash with the revolution's aims of liberty and equality? Let's break into small groups to analyze primary sources from this period and discuss their significance.

(After group discussions)

Let's come back together. I'll ask some checkpoint questions to ensure we understand these concepts before we conclude our lesson.

Blackboard Notes: Today's Topic: The Reign of Terror

- Definition: A period characterized by extreme violence and political purges
- Impact on Revolution:
 - Challenges to liberty and equality
 - Use of the guillotine as a tool of terror
- Key Questions:
 - How did the Reign of Terror affect revolutionary ideals?

Activity (Group Discussion and Analysis, 25 min): 1. Divide students into small groups of 4-5 and distribute copies of primary source documents. 2. Provide each group with poster paper and markers. 3. Give students 10 minutes to read and discuss the documents, focusing on their significance and how they relate to the Reign of Terror. 4. Hand out guiding questions to help facilitate discussion, such as 'How do these documents reflect the political climate during the Reign of Terror?' and 'What consequences did these events have on revolutionary ideals?' 5. After discussion, instruct each group to summarize their findings on the poster paper. They'll prepare to present their key points to the class in the next segment.

Activity (Role Play, 15 min): 1. Assign each student a historical figure associated with the Reign of Terror (e.g., Maximilien Robespierre, Georges Danton, a victim of the guillotine). 2. Give them a few minutes to prepare their character's perspective and contribution to the Reign of Terror, including how their actions reflected or contradicted the ideals of liberty and equality. 3. Set a scene for a town hall meeting where students can present their character's views and answer questions from others. 4. Encourage students to embody their characters and engage in dialogue with one another, asking questions to challenge each other's ideologies.

Activity (Exit Ticket Reflection, 5 min): 1. Hand out an index card to each student as they prepare to leave. 2. Instruct them to write down one sentence explaining how the Reign of Terror impacted the goals of the French Revolution. 3. Collect the index cards as students exit the room, allowing time for a few students to share their responses if time permits.

Exit Ticket: In one sentence, explain how the Reign of Terror impacted the goals of the French Revolution.

Homework: Write a short essay discussing the Reign of Terror's effects on the French society and revolution. Include examples and potential implications for future movements for democracy.

Mentor Moment: Before we finish, I want to share a story about standing by your principles. During the French Revolution, many faced immense pressure to conform. Some chose silence over conflict, while others

bravely voiced their beliefs, even at great personal risk. Think about how this mirrors our own lives-are we willing to stand for what we believe in, even in tough circumstances?

Period 5: Lessons from the French Revolution

Entry Ticket: Reflecting on what we've learned, what do you think are the main ideals of the French Revolution that still resonate today?

Teacher Script: Good morning, everyone! As we gather for our final lesson on the French Revolution, I want us to think about the broader implications of this significant event. The revolution was not just about overthrowing a monarchy; it was also about the ideals of liberty, equality, and citizenship. We'll explore how these principles have shaped modern democracy and human rights. Let's discuss how the storming of the Bastille marked a pivotal moment of change and what it symbolizes even today. Think about how our discussions and understanding of the French Revolution can relate to contemporary social movements. Remember, this is our chance to synthesize everything we've learned. Let's make this a dynamic conversation! I encourage you to think critically and share personal insights as we dive deeper into today's topics.

Blackboard Notes: Main ideals of the French Revolution: liberty, equality, citizenship.

Storming of the Bastille: pivotal moment in the revolution.

Impact on modern democracy and human rights.

Principles influencing contemporary social movements.

Activity (Group Discussion, 20 min): 1. Divide the class into small groups of 4-5 students. 2. Instruct each group to reflect on their learning about the French Revolution and discuss how its principles of liberty, equality, and citizenship relate to modern social movements. 3. Provide each group with the checkpoint questions as a guide for their discussion. They should appoint a spokesperson to share their main ideas with the class afterward. 4. Allow groups to share their insights with the class, encouraging other students to ask questions for clarification or expansion of ideas.

Activity (Role Play, 15 min): 1. Assign each group a specific role related to the French Revolution (e.g., revolutionaries, government leaders, common people, women's rights activists) and give them 5 minutes to develop a short skit illustrating how their group contributed to or was affected by the revolution. 2. Provide them with index cards to write down key points or lines for their skit. 3. After preparation, have each group perform their skit in front of the class. 4. During the skits, students should focus on illustrating the ideals of the revolution that resonate today. After each performance, allow a brief discussion to connect their skit to modern implications.

Activity (Reflection Writing, 10 min): 1. Ask students to take out a piece of paper and write a personal reflection based on the exit ticket prompt. 2. Encourage them to think critically about one lesson from the French Revolution that they believe is most relevant to their lives today, providing reasons and examples for their choice. 3. Give them approximately 5-7 minutes for writing. 4. When they finish, invite a few volunteers to share their reflections with the class.

Exit Ticket: What is one lesson from the French Revolution that you believe is most relevant to our lives today, and why?

Homework: Write a one-page reflection on how the French Revolution has influenced a specific modern social movement or democratic principle. Be sure to include examples.

Mentor Moment: Let me share a story with you about a young activist named Malala Yousafzai. Like the revolutionaries who fought for their rights, she stood up for her belief in education for girls, even in the face of extreme danger. Malala's courage mirrors the passion and ideals of the French Revolution-liberty and equality are worth fighting for, even centuries later. As we move forward in our own lives, it's essential to remember that our voices can instigate change just like the voices of the revolutionaries did in France.